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[00:13:13] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons that are entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:13:30] The members will rise and be led by prayer by Rabbi Rochelle Salston, Temple Beth-El, Richmond, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Good afternoon. Thank you to all the members of the House of Delegates and all those assembled here this afternoon for this great honor.

[00:13:56] Thank you for continued support of the Jewish community and standing against anti-Semitism and bigotry of all kinds in our great Commonwealth. May the one known by so many names, including in my tradition, Melech O'Hev Sedaka Umishpat, sovereign lover of justice and righteousness, pour out blessing upon the Commonwealth of Virginia, upon its residents, its delegates, and officials, faithfully devoting themselves to the needs of the public.

[00:14:23] Today is the Jewish holiday of Purim, in which we read the story of how Queen Esther and her adopted father Mordecai saved the Jewish people from annihilation in the ancient kingdom of Persia. The decree to murder the Jews came about through the legal proceedings of government at that time, through the signature of a wickedly apathetic ruler.

[00:14:46] In this story, we learn of the horrors that may arise when those with greatest power appease their friends and their own egos, ignoring their obligation to preserve the safety and dignity of all those whom they govern. Although the massacre originally decreed as avoided, which is what is celebrated by Jews to this day, the story still ends with chaos and state-sanctioned bloodshed.

[00:15:09] This is not a story we are to emulate. It is read as a cautionary tale. Instead, may we learn compassion and love rather than indifference or malicious vengeance. And may we extend equitable justice and services to all who dwell in our commonwealth, our nation, and our world.

[00:15:26] May we come together across our differences and egos to serve the commonwealth of Virginia and all of its inhabitants in this time of escalating terrible war. I pray may the one who makes peace in the heavens bring peace to us, our nation, the Middle East, and to the entire world.

[00:15:44] And let us say, amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the world.

[00:16:06] Members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:16:27] Clerk will close the row. Mr. Speaker, who are you, Mr. President? I'm going to House Rule 3. I've examined and approved the Journal of the House of Delegates for March 2, 2026. Motions of resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications?

[00:16:44] Yes, sir, Mr. Speaker, communication from the Senate. The Senate has rejected the House amendments to the following legislation, Senate Bill 692. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House insist on its amendments and request committees of conference on the previously reported legislation.

[00:17:01] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House insist on the previously announced legislation and insist on a committee of conference. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Ms. Speaker, remind the House or inform the House, there is a supplemental calendar today that's available.

[00:17:18] Nothing on it is live. Tomorrow's deadline for revenue bills and budget bills. So this is just trying to get everything in the right posture. Ms. Speaker, pursuant to House Rule 40, Speaker, request that you use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board.

[00:17:36] Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today's invocation was given by Rabbi Rachel Salston of Temple Bethel here in Richmond. Rabbi Salston graduated from Brandeis University before attending the Ziegler School of Rabbinic Studies in Los Angeles.

[00:17:58] She served as a hospital chaplain during the height of the COVID-19 epidemic, as well as ritual director at Park Avenue Synagogue and then rabbi of Fair Lawn Jewish Center in her home state of New Jersey. As rabbi of Temple Bethel, she takes great pride in helping individuals find a personal connection with Jewish life and community.

[00:18:21] I hope you'll join me in giving her a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Loeningberg, Delegate Wright.

[00:18:40] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen, I rise for an introduction and a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, I rise today to speak in remembrance of a constituent of mine, Virginia Estelle Phillips-Bell, a super centenarian who was born January 29th, 1914, and was a distinguished member of the Mecklenburg County community.

[00:19:14] We passed a memorial resolution, H.J.R. 101, on February 2, 2026, honoring her life. The Bell family and friends have joined us today in the gallery, and I ask that they now rise.

[00:19:37] And let's give them a warm house welcome, please.

[00:19:47] Virginia Bell was a witness to nearly every major event of the 20th century, from World War I and the Great Depression to World War II, the Civil Rights Movement, the moon landing, and the rise of modern technology.

[00:20:09] Virginia Bell and her husband Henry lovingly raised four children and spent her entire adult life on their family farm, where they raised tobacco, worked the land, and built a home filled with love, faith, and hard work.

[00:20:25] Virginia Bell was widely known for the exceptional care she provided for her family and to the entire Northview community, generously sharing the harvest from her garden, offering kindness to her neighbors and uplifting all who crossed her path.

[00:20:42] She took great pride in the tidiness and beauty of her home, both inside and out, tending to her yard, her flowers, and her surroundings with diligence and joy. She was hailed as the queen of the kitchen, whose coconut pies and fried chicken were renowned among family members and friends.

[00:21:05] Ms. Bell was a lifelong member of Northview Baptist Church, now celebrating its 150th anniversary, where she worshipped faithfully for decades and remained spiritually active, even after moving to an assisted living home at the age of 100, participating fully in religious and recreational activities.

[00:21:29] Upon her 111th birthday on January 29, 2025, Virginia Bell was the oldest living person in the Commonwealth and the 62nd oldest living person in the United States. Ms. Bell died on November 13, 2025 at the incredible age of 111 and will be remembered as a beloved matriarch of a large family and will be fondly remembered and greatly missed by her children and their families and numerous other family members and friends.

[00:22:06] Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns in the honor and memory of Virginia Estelle Phillips Bell. The delegate from Lundenberg, Delegate Wright, moves that when the House adjourns today, it do so in the honor and memory of Virginia Estelle Phillips Bell.

[00:22:24] All those in favor of the motion shall rise. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Royal Oak City, Delegate Rasul.

[00:22:49] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, I'd like to welcome those who are affiliated with the Senator Frank Ruff Center for Rural Virginia, if they could please rise.

[00:23:05] These include board members of the Virginia Rural Center, graduates of the Virginia Rural Leadership Institute, and supporters of the Rural Center. Recognizing them on behalf of my board members as well, Delegate Lawford, Delegate Clark, and Delegate Runyon.

[00:23:22] The Virginia Rural Center is a partnership between the Center for Rural Virginia and the Council for Rural Virginia, which advances programs, Mr. Speaker, like the Virginia Rural Leadership Institute. And it's one of the signature initiatives that we find.

[00:23:41] This brings emerging and established leaders across Virginia to deepen their understanding of opportunities and situations that we see across every corner of Virginia. Yeah. I've seen some bright people who are genuinely concerned about how to move the Commonwealth along, Mr. Speaker. And they've also educated people that the furthest western point of Virginia is further west than Detroit. That's how big Virginia is. I hope you'll join me

[00:24:11] in giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Campbell County. Delegate is there.

[00:24:26] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Rising for a motion and an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that H.R. 134 be taken out of the block, and speaking to that motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery, we have my neighbor, my friend, Justin Lynchard.

[00:24:45] And Justin, could I get you and your family to stand up, please? Justin is a retired member of the U.S. Army and a recent recipient of an honorary promotion to sergeant from the United States House Committee on Armed Services and the United States Secretary of the Army.

[00:25:04] What makes that most amazing is that just a few years ago, Justin was struck by a vehicle after a pre-deployment exercise while serving with the 101st Airborne Division. He suffered a stroke, traumatic brain injury, and spent 17 days in a coma.

[00:25:20] But Mr. Speaker, Justin doesn't give up. And after a year of pushing himself, he recovered use of his limbs and continues to work to recover cognitive abilities. He's an inspiration to his community and exemplifies fortitude and perseverance in the face of life-altering challenges.

[00:25:38] Therefore, Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of H.R. 134 and ask that the members join me in extending to Justin and his family a warm House welcome. The delegate from Campbell County moves that the House adopt House Resolution 134, commending Justin D. Lynchard.

[00:25:59] All those in favor will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Congratulations, sir. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price.

[00:26:23] Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, today we have with us some pre-law students from Hampton University, and I ask that they please stand. They are shadowing the Hampton Commonwealth's attorney, Anton Bell, today, learning about the legislative process and how the General Assembly's work overlaps with the work of the Commonwealth's attorney.

[00:26:45] To encourage their inquisitiveness and dedication, I hope we will all give them a warm house welcome. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:27:04] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today I rise to recognize the American-Turkish Friendship Association, known as ATFA, who are present in the Capitol, and I ask them to please rise in the gallery.

[00:27:21] ATFA is a 501c3 nonprofit organization serving communities across Northern Virginia and throughout the Commonwealth through interfaith dialogue, community service initiatives, youth leadership development, and cultural exchange programs. I do want to invite this evening, ATFA is hosting its annual State House Iftar dinner at 5.30 p.m. at St. Paul's Episcopal Church in Richmond.

[00:27:43] We hope that you can all join, and I also hope that you please join me in welcoming Outfit to the gallery today and giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:28:01] Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Maida. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that HJR 198, found on page 55 of the calendar, be passed by until Monday, March 9th.

[00:28:20] Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate, May the moves that HJR 198 be passed by until March 9th. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Bill is passed by until March 9th.

[00:28:36] Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House take up out of order House Resolution 184 on page 20, and I'd like to speak to that motion. Clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution 184, commending Gwendolyn Davis-Hawley, DDS.

[00:28:54] Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Dr. Gwendolyn Davis-Holly has joined us in the chamber along with her friends and family in the gallery, and while she may be surprised by this, I ask that she please stand. Today is Dr. Davis-Holly's 80th birthday, a distinguished dentist and a champion of public health who has dedicated more than four decades to the field of dentistry and the advancement of oral health.

[00:29:25] Dr. Davis-Hawley's extraordinary career spans private practice, public health dentistry, non-profit clinical leadership, and institutional service. She played an instrumental role in launching a dental clinic for Horizon Health Services, which expanded care to underserved communities.

[00:29:42] Dr. Davis-Hawley also provided comprehensive dental services to incarcerated individuals, often treating complex restorative cases at the Virginia Department of Corrections from 2010 to 2022. She has received many awards and accolades over the years, including recognition from the Hampton Roads Chamber of Commerce and the NAACP, along with the appointments to the Virginia Voluntary Formulary Board under Governor Chuck Robb and Governor Gerald Bouliles.

[00:30:08] So today, on her 80th birthday, with her daughter at hand, we celebrate her lifelong commitment to equity in health care and her wonderful career improving the oral health of her patients. I move the, and with that, I move the resolution.

[00:30:32] The delegate from James C. County, Delegate Andrews, moves that the House adopt House Resolution 184, commending Gwendolyn Davis-Holly DDS. All those in favor of the motion shall say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations.

[00:30:54] Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:31:10] I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House take up out-of-order H.R. 199 on page 55 of today's calendar. Clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution 199, commending the Ely Project. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins.

[00:31:27] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move adoption of the resolution and I request to speak to the motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.R. 199 recognizes the efforts and contributions of the Ely Project, a nonprofit organization dedicated to preserving and promoting the legacy of the Honorable Roland J. Duke Ely and fostering greater understanding of the history of Jackson Ward in Richmond and the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[00:31:54] Members of the Ely Project are with us in the gallery today, and I ask that they please rise. The work of Roland J. Duke Ely, an accomplished civil rights lawyer and former House of Delegates member, whose legal and political career spanned over 50 years, impacted countless lives across the state.

[00:32:13] The Ely Project is dedicated to identifying and preserving documents that shed light on his contributions to the civil rights movement, the Richmond legal system, and the development of Jackson Ward, which are archived and digitized through a deed of gift to the Library of Virginia.

[00:32:30] The collection spans six decades of legal work from 1940 to 1992. In addition to preservation, the Ely Project collects oral histories from longtime Jackson Wart residents, develops research into family displacement from the interstate highway system, and creates educational resources illuminating these stories.

[00:32:51] Mr. Speaker, I want to thank the Ely Project for their continued work, and I move adoption of the resolution. The delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins, moves that we adopt House Resolution 199, commending the Ely Project.

[00:33:06] All those in favor shall say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations.

[00:33:20] Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that we take up HJ 195, adopt it, and I request to speak to that motion. Clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution 195, commending the Save a Truck Foundation.

[00:33:38] Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I'd like to speak about an organization called Save a Truck and ask that its team joining us in the gallery, please rise. Mr. Speaker, Seva Truck is a non-profit food truck that delivers warm and nutritious vegetarian meals to students at Title I schools.

[00:33:57] The term Seva means service. It's one of the core values of the Sikh religion. Sikhism's three core tenets are work hard, serve others, and believe in a higher power. Mr. Speaker, the Seva Truck Foundation epitomizes those Sikh and truly American values.

[00:34:16] With their mobile food truck, Save-A-Truck Foundation offers up to 800 freshly prepared nutritious meals daily. As a result of their tireless efforts over the past 10 years, the Save-A-Truck Foundation has served more than 550,000 meals to children and families in need.

[00:34:37] The schools where they have the largest presence are Braddock Elementary, Annandale Terrace, Sleepy Hollow, Coates, and Bailey's Elementary. Mr. Speaker, on behalf of Delegates Herring, Watts, Sullivan, Simon, Shin, and Sebald, who represent areas where Save-A-Truck has a robust presence, I move the adoption of HJ195, commending Save-A-Truck on its 10 years of service to the community.

[00:35:03] Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh moves House Joint Resolution 195, commending the Save-A-Truck Foundation. All those in favor shall say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations. Thank you. Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Glass.

[00:35:30] Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. They often say that we are exchanging our trauma for change. And that is especially beautiful when we have young people at the helm.

[00:35:49] Today in the audience, we have Spartans for Change, and I would ask them to please rise. Spartan for Change. They are a student-led organization, Mr. Speaker, that have been active since November 2025 and have currently over 50 members.

[00:36:08] This organization of amazing young people, young adults, are here to serve the broader community and recognize that's work that they need to do. They are here to learn how to become socially responsible individuals. This organization, Spartans for Change, are also a part of creating a space for students at Norfolk State University to have the opportunity to actually engage in advocacy at a macro level.

[00:36:35] Spartan for Change is committed to enhancing social action, to mobilizing young people around topics that directly impact them. Today in the gallery we have their executive team and several body members that represent a diverse educational background from social work to business management.

[00:36:54] I would ask that the House please give Spartans for change, the amazing Spartans for change, a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:37:14] Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House take up out of order House Joint Resolution 124 on page 20, and I ask to speak to that motion. Clerk will pour the resolution. Excuse me, House Joint Resolution 124, celebrating the life of Edith Marie Kearney Hurd.

[00:37:36] The delegate from James City Council, delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The family of Edith Marie Kearney Hurd has joined us in the gallery today, and I ask that they please stand for recognition. Edith Hurd, affectionately known as Cookie by all who knew her, was a cherished member of the greater Williamsburg community, a true trailblazer.

[00:37:56] Her professional career took her on many paths, from her employment as one of the first black employees in Colonial Williamsburg's accounting office to her role in the local labor movement. In the late 1960s, she played an instrumental role in the establishment of the Colonial Williamsburg Food and Beverage Workers Union and later served as union vice president when they merged with hotel employees and restaurant employees, International Union Local 32.

[00:38:21] A champion for workers' rights, Cookie not only understood there was strength in solidarity, but she organized for a better future for workers. Cookie was involved in countless local causes that were near and dear to her heart. She was integral in fostering the relationship between the College of William & Mary and the local black community.

[00:38:39] She contributed to the education of young people through her involvement with the Lemon Project, a journey of reconciliation, along with a course that culminated the creation of the Hearth Memorial to the Enslaved at William & Mary. I had the privilege of meeting Cookie in 2023 and was at once inspired by her passion and her drive to serve and educate her community.

[00:38:58] Cookie was someone who was unapologetically told you what you needed to hear and pushed you to be the absolute best version of yourself. I am so grateful that I got to know her before her passing. Cookie's 83 years of life were led with great purpose, and it was an honor to know her and call her a friend.

[00:39:16] And with that, Mr. Speaker, I ask that we move the resolution and adjourn today in the memory and honor of Edith Cookie Kearney Hurd. The delegate from James City County moves the adoption of House Joint Resolution 124, celebrating the life of Edith Marie Kearney Hurd, and that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns in the unearned memory of Edith Marie Kearney Hurd.

[00:39:40] Those in favor of the motion shall please rise. The resolution is agreed to. So in the House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business or a granted leave from today's session.

[00:40:07] Delegate Carlson. Clerk will announce the next order of business. I can portion of the morning hours are for the announcement of a member request for legislation to be moved from an uncontested calendar to a regular calendar. There are three in that first category, Senate Bill's third, uncontested. Page two of the printed calendar, Senator Rome's SB 164, excuse me, Senator McPike's SB 164 is out of the block over to the regular calendar.

[00:40:31] Page four, Senator Diggs, SB 396, over to the regular calendar, out of the block, and Senator Ciphers, SB 767 on page six. The latter two by the request of Delegate Wyatt, the first by Delegate Tran.

[00:40:48] The clerk will announce the next item. Third portion of the morning hour, remember requests for legislation go by for the day, and if such, the motion by the Majority Leader. There is just one on that same bill we just spoke a moment ago. Page 2, Senator McPike's SB 164 is requested to go by for the day.

[00:41:06] Request to Delegate Tran. Mr. Speaker, I move the legislation.

[00:41:25] I apologize. So Senate Bill 386, patron by Senator Stewart, is what is actually requested to go by for the day. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation, as announced by the clerk, go by for the day.

[00:41:41] Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Harry Moosa, the legislation that's announced by the clerk go by for the day. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to. Clerk will announce the next. And the fourth and final portion of the morning hour reserve for member requests for points of personal privilege. Delegate from Colonial Heights, Delegate Cherry. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:41:57] I request to return to the first morning hour for the purpose of a motion. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that H.J.R. 135, found on page 20, be taken up out of order, and I'd like to adopt the resolution in speaking to that motion. Clerk will report a resolution. House Storm Resolution 135, commending Joseph P. Casey, Ph.D.

[00:42:16] Vidalic from Kelowna Heights, you have the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, joining us in the gallery today is Chesterfield County Administrator Dr. Joe Casey, and I'd ask him and the people with him to please rise in support. He's joined by his wife, Suzanne, and several members of the Chesterfield County Board of Supervisors.

[00:42:32] Dr. Casey is retiring soon, though we're not really happy about that, but apparently he's been around long enough that we have to let him do that. He did not begin his career in Chesterfield, he

actually began as my colleague noted here behind me over in Hanover and then he did some time in Henrico, neither of which were really up to his standards.

[00:42:52] So he came and landed in Chesterfield for the last 10 years he has been our county administrator. He has served very, very well in that capacity and I believe many would count it as an outstanding job that he's done in representing us. I'd encourage you all to read the resolution, we try not to do those on the floor, but just to see how many things he's accomplished throughout his career as a government servant in our community, and we're so grateful for that. I think all of us in this room know how important it is to have strong leadership in your counties and in your localities, and with that, we have been very lucky in Chesterfield to have him at the helm for the last 10 years. So

[00:43:30] I ask, Mr. Speaker, once again, I renew my motion to adopt the resolution. Delegate from Colonial Heights, Delegate Cherry, moves that the House adopt House Joint Resolution 135, commending Joseph P. Casey, Ph.D.

[00:43:45] All those in favor of the motion shall say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. And we would give him a warm House welcome. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Converse Fowler.

[00:44:05] Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, there's a question that has echoed across generations. How many Einsteins have spent their lives washing dishes? How many Mozarts bent over stoves instead of pianos because they had the misfortune of being born a woman?

[00:44:25] We may never know how many are overlooked. Like Lisa Metner, she helped unlock the science of nuclear fission. Yet when the Nobel Prize honored that discovery, the recognition went to her male collaborator. Maria Anna Mozart toured Europe as a prodigy and composed her own music, only to have her career curtailed because society decided a woman did not belong on the stage.

[00:44:52] The Bronte sisters, Charlotte, Emily, and Anne, published their novels under male pseudonyms because they knew their work would not be taken seriously if the world knew it was written by a woman. Their brilliance was never the question. What was missing was recognition.

[00:45:10] Mr. Speaker, in athletics, in science, in literature, and in public service, women continue to set a standard of excellence, and they deserve to be recognized, starting with the United States women's hockey team, a program that has earned medals at every Olympic game since its debut in 1998 and continues to inspire the next generation of athletes. That's not a coincidence.

[00:45:35] That's dominance. And in the most recent history, in the most recent victory, history expanded once again as Layla Edwards became the first black woman to win Olympic gold for the United States women's hockey team, widening the circle of who sees themselves on that podium. And yet, They were part of a larger narrative that distracted from their victory.

[00:45:59] Women's achievements should be celebrated without distraction and without negative comparison. Mr. Speaker, here in Virginia, I am proud to raise three daughters in a Commonwealth where women do not wait for validation to lead, we do not wait for permission to win, and we certainly do not shrink when recognition is withheld.

[00:46:19] Happy Women's History Month to the women of this chamber and to the women across the Commonwealth and who make Virginia stronger every single day. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from

Scott County, Delegate Kilgore.

[00:46:41] Mr. Speaker, rise for a point of personal privilege. Delegate, that's the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, Stephanie Minter was 41 years old. She lived in Fredericksburg. Her parents described her as being a light in a dark world.

[00:46:58] Stephanie Minter bled to death in Fairfax County. Not a war zone, not in some lawless country, but here in the Commonwealth of Virginia. She was stabbed by a man who had been arrested 30 times, 30 times.

[00:47:15] Rape charges, assault, malicious wounding, multiple stabbings, police encounters dating back years. He was in this country illegally. He had an ice detainer. He had a final order of removal, and he was still here.

[00:47:34] One of his prior victims described being stabbed outside of 7-Eleven. the knife broke in the attack. The gentleman survived. The attacker pled guilty and received two years with most of his sentence suspended. That victim said something haunting. He said, I figured when he got out, they would do something with him. That's what normal people think, Mr. Speaker, that when someone stabs people repeatedly, the system eventually protects the public. Instead, Stephanie Mentor is dead. And even now, we're told cooperation with federal

[00:48:13] authorities requires more paperwork, more delays, more excuses. Now, folks, we're not talking about raids. We're not talking about profiling. We're not talking about even holding someone past or lawful sentencing. We're talking about a phone call, a phone call so that federal officers can go and take custody of a violent felon at a jail door not on our streets even now our governor says ice must get a judicial warrant before this killer will be turned over to ice 30 arrests multiple stabbings a removal order an ice

[00:48:52] detainer and somehow the governor will not cooperate mr. speaker at what point this public safety outweigh politics at what point do we decide that protecting Virginians matters more than posturing. Mr. Speaker, Stephanie Mentor does not get another chance. We shouldn't need another body to fix this. Mr. Speaker, thank you.

[00:49:22] The delegate from Stafford, Delegate Carroll. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, March is Women's History Month. And what other way to celebrate women than to acknowledge those that have shaped our commonwealth and impacted this country?

[00:49:46] Most often without recognition while overcoming extraordinary obstacles, roadblocks, speed bumps, hurdles, and some that were created simply because of our gender. Mr. Speaker, I stand today to discuss a woman, a trailblazer in the fight about money and the belief that all people should have access to it.

[00:50:06] In 1903, Maggie Lena Walker became the first African-American woman to charter a bank and the first African-American woman to serve as a bank president. She saw her community needed capital and decided to build something to support that need.

[00:50:23] She founded St. Luke Penny Savings Bank right here in Richmond. She refused to accept the limits society placed on her. During the Great Depression, nearly 40% of all banks and financial institutions failed, wiping out billions in savings for Americans.

[00:50:41] But you know what, Mr. Speaker? That St. Luke Penny Savings Bank survived the Great Depression. It is known as one of the longest-standing black-owned financial institutions in history. Through mergers and acquisitions, St. Luke's was consolidated with another well-known bank that still thrives today.

[00:51:01] Maggie Lena Walker did not wait for permission. She built institutions, opportunities, and power. And because she did then, today I can. Mr. Speaker, women today are leading banks, leading businesses in public service, and in finance right here in this very chamber.

[00:51:20] Mr. Speaker, I am reminded that because of her trailblazing efforts, today there are nearly 20 banks that are designated as women-owned by the Office of Comptroller of Currency. Most of these banks are in the Midwest and Southwest Central states.

[00:51:35] But we will never forget where the real example and foundation was laid. That's right here in Richmond. Mr. Speaker, Women's History Month is more than just remembering names. It's about recognizing power, power that built women who refused to be shut out.

[00:51:52] Her story reminds us that when women are given a chance, a seat at the table, or in some cases we create the table ourselves, entire communities are strengthened. Mr. Speaker, her bank offered loans to families and forged pathways to home ownership for so many.

[00:52:09] Loans that we now may use to purchase cars and other items that were critical for advancement at that time. Simple luxuries and accesses that most of us often take for granted today. She made it a priority to hire women, creating jobs and building economic independence during a time when few others would.

[00:52:30] Mr. Speaker, Maggie Lena Walker is a trailblazer worth honoring today. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett.

[00:52:53] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I request a return to the first morning hour for the purposes of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery, we're joined by the AP senior government class from Fluvanna County High School. Mr. Speaker, wow. I love to speak to young people, particularly young people as impressive as these.

[00:53:10] Today, Mr. Speaker, we discussed great people, including Lock, Hume, Hobbs, Jefferson, Churchill, Barbara Johns, Vernon Johns, Ronald Reagan, and Speaker Don L. Scott. We did. We discussed imperfect people, Mr. Speaker, and near-perfect ideas. We discussed how government does work and how government should work.

[00:53:26] And what I found uniformly was a passionate, well-reasoned series of arguments. I do want to know, Mr. Speaker, whether the delegate from Prince William County got to them first because I got a great argument on HB14. They almost swayed me. But, Mr. Speaker, these young people are the future.

[00:53:43] I wanted to ask my colleagues to join me in welcoming them to the Virginia House of Delegates and saying, guys, go out and make it better than you found it. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:54:03] The delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I request that we return to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Here, Mr. Speaker, on the dais to your left is Ms. Linda Jackson.

[00:54:22] She is here from the Minnesota Senate Journal Office. She's here for a week as part of the American Society of Legislative Clerks and Secretaries, and we welcome her. Give her a warm-house welcome. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer.

[00:54:47] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, we just heard from the other side about a terrible tragedy, a person who was murdered. But I want to talk about the real heart of that tragedy for a second.

[00:55:02] The real tragedy is that for four years, the previous gubernatorial administration, the previous attorney general, was so consumed with creating fake election integrity units, with distracting our resources and the National Guard and the police to try to take innocent people off the streets, that instead of keeping our communities safe, instead of getting criminals out of our commonwealth in jail and out of our country, they left them there.

[00:55:30] Let's be honest. Right now, MAGA and their policies are resulting in the deaths of Americans around the country and around the world as we watch U.S. troops die for the ego of Donald Trump.

[00:55:47] So let's be real here for a second. There was a terrible tragedy in Fairfax County. That tragedy was born by the misuse of resources, by the failure to keep our community safe, that time and again was the policy of four years of the previous administration.

[00:56:02] And I'm really excited that we have new leadership and a new way ahead in Virginia to make sure that every Virginian feels safe in their community. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams.

[00:56:24] Yes, Mr. Speaker, rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, are you kidding me? Are you kidding me? From 2019 and 2020, this body, the majority, the last trifecta, passed every single terrible criminal justice reform bill that you could possibly pass that eliminated every single thing that we could possibly do to pull somebody over and try to see.

[00:56:52] Maybe they've got drugs running up down 95 or they've got human trafficking in the back of their truck bed. You've got no cash bond. You ended that. That means anybody comes and goes whenever they like. I cannot count the number of illegal immigrants and violent felons that have gotten out over the last four to six years under the Soros-backed Commonwealth's attorneys within Virginia who continue to cause havoc and chaos in your own communities, guys.

[00:57:28] I love my Commonwealth's attorney. She will put you under the jail. Not in Northern Virginia. You can walk right out and stab somebody. Maybe you guys could take a look at knife legislation later. This is ridiculous. Getting up here and lecturing us again about things that you all created.

[00:57:47] And then, last but not least, create the crisis and then offer the solution. That is what we see. That is what we see from the colleagues on the other side of the room. And the fact that we continue to get lectured and lectured and lectured while victims, Real victims out there watch what happens on this House floor.

[00:58:10] And again, they hear about Donald Trump more than they hear about their own troubles and trauma. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The clerk will call a calendar.

[00:58:30] The calendar for the Virginia House of Delegates this Tuesday, March 3rd, 2026. Approximately 50 bills to be dispensed with, beginning with the first category, set of bills on third reading or final passage

in the uncontested calendar. Page one, first up, Senate Bill 41, which seeks to amend and reenact Sex, Dakota, Virginia, relating to the Virginia voluntary contributions during electronic Department of Motor Vehicle Transactions.

[00:58:55] Legislation report, committee on transportation. Senator from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 41 requires the DMV to provide a method by which an individual conducting an electronic transaction may make a voluntary contribution to the Virginia Highway Safety Improvement Fund. I hope it is the will of the body to pass this legislation.

[00:59:12] Turning to page two, continuing with the uncontested calendar block, Senate Bill 95 now before you. Sixth Amendment re-enact section of the Code of Virginia relating to rest area signage, human trafficking information. This legislation also is reporting committee on transportation. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:59:28] Senate Bill 95 requires information about human trafficking and how to self-identify the signs of human trafficking to be posted at all rest areas along any interstate highway. I hope it is the will of the body to pass this legislation. Senate Bill 164 in the printed calendar is by for the day. Senate Bill 165 is next up in the Uncontested Calendar Block.

[00:59:45] It seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to contracts, retainage bonds permitted, and construction contracts, legislation on general laws. Deluxe from Fairfax, another good reason. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 165 relates to construction contracts and payment security practices.

[01:00:00] It authorizes the use of retainage bonds as an alternative to withholding retainage payments in construction projects. What it does is it modernizes construction contracting in Virginia by allowing bonding options that protect project owners while ensuring contractors are paid for work already completed.

[01:00:16] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill passes. Senate Bill 166 is now before you. It seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia Land Insurance, contingent deferred annuities. Legislation report goody on labor and commerce. The delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:00:31] Mr. Speaker, this bill permits the State Corporation Commission to adopt reasonable standards for contingent deferred annuities and the bill subjects contingent deferred annuities to certain requirements applicable applicable under current law to other types of insurance mr speaker i move passage of the bill next up in the block senate bill 278 would direct the secretary of health and human service health and human resources to convene a stakeholder work group to conduct a comprehensive evaluation of the impacts of the federal 304 340b drug pricing program within the Commonwealth report.

[01:01:08] Legislation report committee on health and human services with amendments. Delegate from Henrico, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the House adopt the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendments are agreed to the delegate from Henrico, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:01:23] SB 278 directs the Health and Human Resources Secretary to establish a work group to evaluate the 340B drug pricing program and its impact on the Commonwealth. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Continuing with the block, top of page four of the printed calendar, Senate Bill 300. 909 seeks to

amend to reenact a section of the code of Virginia related to driver education programs, voluntary initiatives for drivers diagnosed with autism spectrum disorder.

[01:01:45] Legislation report committee on transportation. Delegate Delaney. Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 309 requires driver education programs to include information about voluntary initiatives for drivers with autism spectrum disorder. This bill also directs the Board of Education to prepare, publish and distribute instructional materials about these voluntary initiatives, and I hope it is the will of the body to pass the legislation.

[01:02:04] Next up in the uncontested block is Senate Bill 321, which seeks to amend and re-enact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to abandonment of highway, section of the secondary state highway system, local authority, legislation and reporting committee on transportation. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:02:20] Senate Bill 321 allows localities to abandon a section of the secondary state highway system that no longer needs public highway designation. I hope it is the will of the body to pass this legislation. Senate Bill 396 on page four is over to the regular calendar. Therefore, continuing with the uncontested third reading calendar block, Senate Bill 399 seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to driver training school and driver training instructors standards, discipline, report.

[01:02:42] Legislation, again, report to the Committee on Transportation. Delegate from Hanover, Delegate White. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 399 is cognate to my bill, House Bill 559, that passed this chamber 97-0. This restricts a license for a driver training school instructor for those convicted of any sex crimes or traffic-related felonies.

[01:03:03] Also creates a database. I move passage of the bill. Next up, Senate Bill 409, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Land Assisted Living Facilities, Electronic Monitoring in Resident Rooms, Legislative Reporting Committee on Health and Human Services. Delegate from Morocco, Delegate Willett.

[01:03:18] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 409 allows assisted living facility residents to install electronic monitoring devices. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Senate Bill 594, now before you, would amend the Code of Virginia Land to motor vehicle insurance, unauthorized edition of insured drivers prohibited.

[01:03:36] Legislation for the Committee on Labor and Commerce. Delegate from Hampton County, Delegate War. Could this bill go by temporarily?

[01:03:52] Without objection, SB 594 goes by temporarily. Over on page six, we come next in this uncontested block to Senate Bill 633, which would direct the Department of Health to publish resources regarding emergency medical services and medical support for events.

[01:04:09] Legislation report committed on health and human services. Dr. Vermeer-Reichel, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 633 indeed directs the Department of Health to publish a document at its website for event planners and venues to its providers about the notice that EMS personnel may be available for large-scale events.

[01:04:25] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill will pass. Senate Bill 767 is out of the block, therefore the next bill in the block, bottom of page 6, Senate Bill 777, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to

regional electric transmission entities. Voting members, annual report, legislation reporting on labor and commerce with an amendment in nature of a substitute.

[01:04:45] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Speaker, I'm sorry, I have to let this pass again also. Without objection, SB 777 goes by temporarily.

[01:05:04] Continuing, the next bill in the uncontested third reading block is top of page 7. Legislation is Senate Bill 790, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to health insurance, mandated benefits, treatment of menopause and perimenopause.

[01:05:25] Again, this legislation reports the Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment in nature of a substitute. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. speaker first of all i need to move the substitute shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye all those opposed no the committee substitutes agree to the delegate from hampton delegate thank you mr speaker first of all the substitute just makes a technical correction and it adds a reenactment clause but what the bill does it requires insurance to provide coverage for mentally medically necessary treatment and care for menopause and perimenopause mr speaker i move passage of the bill returning to one of the other bills that had been taken

[01:06:05] by temporarily over on page five. Page five, we return back to Senate Bill 594, SB 594, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to motor vehicle insurance, unauthorized edition of insured drivers, prohibited legislation before the committee had labor and commerce.

[01:06:23] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. What we do is ensure that those people would not be rejected any type of motor vehicle insurance simply because of their credit rating. I move the substitute first, Mr. Speaker, and passage of the bill.

[01:06:44] Chair, the substitute will be agreed to. All those in favor say aye, all those opposed, no. Committee substitutes agree to. And, Ms. Speaker, last bill in the Senate Bill's third reading, uncontested calendar block, is the bottom of page six.

[01:06:59] Bottom of page six is Senate Bill 777, which had been taken by temporarily. Senate Bill 777 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to regional electric transmission entities, voting members, annual report. This legislation was reported by the Committee on Labor and Commerce, and this does have an amendment nature substitute.

[01:07:19] The delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill go by for the day. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that Senate Bill 777 goes by for the day. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no, the bill is by for the day.

[01:07:35] Ms. Speaker, the block of uncontested third reading final passage bills are now before you. Shall the bills pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:07:53] Ayes 97, noes 0. Ayes 97, noes 0. The bills pass. Continuing with today's calendar, new category, Senate bills on third reading regular. Senate bills third reading regular, approximately 20 or so bills beginning on page 7 of the printed calendar.

[01:08:11] First up in this new category is Senate Bill 661, which seeks to amend and reenact a multitude of sections of the Code of Virginia, all relating to regulation of gaming, commerce, and development in the

Commonwealth. Penalty. Legislative board committee on general laws with the amendment nature of a substitute.

[01:08:28] Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed no, the committee substitute is agreed to. Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, if nothing else on this piece of legislation, the common denominator between this bill and my House Bill 1272, we should all remember we need to stop the illegal machines all over this commonwealth.

[01:08:59] Senate Bill 661 authorizes and specifies the licensing requirements for the manufacture, distribution, operation, hosting, and playing of electronic gaming devices as defined in this bill. The bill imposes a 30% tax on all gross profits from the play of such electronic gaming devices and provides for the use of such tax proceeds.

[01:09:22] The bill also imposes criminal and civil penalties for violations under the law and regulations related to electronic gaming devices. The bill includes a delayed enactment clause as well. Mr. Speaker, the bill also moves from this regulation being under the lottery board to over to the ABC.

[01:09:47] Mr. Speaker, at this time, I'd like to move that the bill passed, but after comments from my colleague from Fairfax County, Delegate Cresick. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill.

[01:10:02] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. We all know that I'm not a fan of skill games. That might be an understatement. As you heard from the delegate, this bill here, as it is before us today, is replete with strong guardrails, which we put on in general laws.

[01:10:25] It requires, as the delegate mentioned, the first and foremost thing it requires, and we've never done this before, is the eradication of all of the illegal games that are out there today, which is, we've heard, somewhere in the north of 90,000.

[01:10:44] That's like 40 casinos worth of slot machines. So my primary goal here, I think our primary goal here is to eradicate that, to get rid of that black market and add appropriate public safety regulations. And you heard a couple of them from the delegate, but I want to add a few more.

[01:11:02] I'm not going to go through all of the belts and suspenders that we've added, but I'm going to give you a couple more. I think it's really important. One is that this is just 15,000 machines, 15,000 machines as opposed to 90,000, 15,000 regulated machines, 15,000 machines that will pay taxes, 15,000 machines that will actually be for kids or for adults, not for kids. Sorry, exactly. They'll only be for adults. Right now, anybody can play those games. You can be, and they've even, they've even self-regulated say 18 and up where all of our, most of all our gaming is at 21 and we've been moving everything up to 21 over the last few

[01:11:42] years. This will be for 21 and up. It will also be the payout. Right now, you don't even know what kind of a payout you're getting if you do play one of those games you may not you may not get anything but it'll be it'll be regulated like a casino payout I think in the bill we say 86% payout every device will be connected to a lottery operated central system tracking cash flow payouts or it's 84% tax accruals malfunctions remote activity just like if they were in a casino it will be the strict host locations there will only allow two two in a in a in an ABC establishment

[01:12:19] been five in a truck stop. I see a lot of white flags being weighed here but this is I want you to know that this has as it stands now this is replete like I said replete with really strong regulations so I'm going to be voting for it and I move I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 57, noes 39, abstentions 1. Ayes 57, noes 39, abstentions 1,

[01:12:57] the bill passes. Senate Bill 386 is by for the day. Therefore, over on page 8, we come next in this third reading regular. Senate Bill 72, now before you, would reduce heating-related costs of living for low-income residents by requiring certain electric utilities provide energy efficiency upgrades. Report legislation recorded from the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[01:13:19] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, All this bill does is reduce heating-related costs for living and low-income residents by requiring certain electric utilities to provide energy efficiency upgrades.

[01:13:38] Mr. Speaker, I move passes of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes.

[01:13:54] 64, noes. 34. Ayes, 64, noes. 34. The bill passes. Senate Bill 73, now before you, would direct the Virginia Department of Medical Assisted Services to train staff in Medicaid billing navigation for certain school services. Legislation Report Committee from Health and Human Services with an amendment.

[01:14:10] Delegate from Enrico. Delegate Willett. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Enrico. Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 73 has amended directs DMAS to train local school staff in how to navigate Medicaid laws and policies so schools may be better equipped to get Medicaid funding opportunities and other student health services in Virginia.

[01:14:32] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 78, noes 20.

[01:14:48] Ayes 78, ayes 79, noes 19, aye, Paul. Ayes 79, noes 19, the bill passes. Continuing over on page 9, we come to Senate Bill 100, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Related to Protection of Employees, Volunteer, Emergency Responders, Civil Action.

[01:15:06] Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, first I move the amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to the delegate from Hampton. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the amendment just simply rewords the sentences on lines 35 to 36 without changing any of the meaning.

[01:15:29] And what the bill does, it prohibits any employer from discharging, disciplining, threatening, or anything of anyone who has taken time off because they are volunteering for emergency responding.

[01:15:45] Mr. Speaker, I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 2.

[01:16:02] Ayes 93, noes 2, the bill passes. Senate Bill 121 seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to minimum wage, farm laborers, or farm employees. Legislation, again, reported to the Committee on Labor and Commerce. Delicate from Arlington, Delicate McClure.

[01:16:18] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB 121 is the cognate to my HB 20. The Senate version, unfortunately, retains the H-2 exemption, but it takes a critical step in moving us closer to finally including farm workers in the Virginia Minimum Wage Act. All stakeholders are committed to continuing the conversation on the H2 exemption, but Mr. Speaker, I am grateful to the Virginia Farm Bureau and the Virginia Agribusiness Council who now support finally including farm workers in the Virginia Minimum Wage Act. It's past time to extend these basic protections to the hardworking people who help feed our commonwealth. Mr. Speaker, I move

[01:16:48] that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, No, it's 35.

[01:17:04] The bill passes. Page 10 of the printed and calendar. Senate Bill's third reading regular. We come to Senate Bill 175. Seeks to amend and reenact two sections. The Code of Virginia relating to electric utilities, renewable energy portfolio, standard program requirements, power purchase agreements, legislation report, committee on labor and commerce with an amendment.

[01:17:27] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, first, I move the amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The amendment simply strikes the third enactment clause, and what the bill does, it amends certain renewable energy portfolio standard program requirements for Dominion Energy Virginia, and it directs the State Corporation Commission to initiate proceedings to evaluate the future availability of renewable energy.

[01:18:00] Mr. Speaker, I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:18:15] Ayes 93, noes 5. Ayes 93, noes 5. The bill passes. Senate Bill 183 would direct the Board of Health to promulgate regulations requiring restaurants to place an identifying marker on delivery or takeaway food altered or substitute due to consumer-identified food allergy or sensitivity.

[01:18:34] Legislation for the Committee on Health and Human Services with an amendment. Delegate from Henrico. Delegate Willett. Mr. Speaker, I move the House adopt the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Henrico. Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB-183 directs the Board of Health to update restaurant regulations to require that if a restaurant provides a food substitute due to an allergy, a marker must be placed in the food to indicate the substitution.

[01:18:58] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 66, noes 32.

[01:19:14] Ayes 66, noes 32. The bill passes. Senate Bill 191 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Land or Railroad Safety, a minimum train crew, movement of freight. This legislation will support the Committee on Labor and Commerce. That's from Norfolk, Delegate Anthony. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 191 is identical to my House Bill 25, which passed this House 66 to 33.

[01:19:37] This bill requires Virginia freight trains to have a minimum two-person crew. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:19:53] Ayes 64, noes 34. Ayes 64, noes 34. The bill passes. Senate Bill 199 now before you, seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Land, Employment, Paid Sick Leave, Civil Penalties, Civil Actions, Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce, with an amendment in nature of a substitute.

[01:20:10] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Mr. Speaker, this bill requires one hour paid sick leave for every 30 hours work for all employees of private employers and state and local governments, with certain exceptions.

[01:20:29] Mr. Speaker, I move passage of this bill. Mr. Speaker, move the substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed on. The delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Move passage of the bill.

[01:20:46] Shall the bill pass? Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Did you hear the delegate from Henry Cochin? I know he always knows I call him. It's Delegate from Patrick. Mr. Speaker speaking to the bill?

[01:21:02] Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, one of the things that we talked about a lot this session is affordability. And we've also talked a lot about taxes, and it's been told to me that we didn't raise any taxes this year. So I was just looking at this bill because there was a new fiscal impact statement that came out yesterday.

[01:21:22] And one of the things I saw in it was that there was no fiscal impact determination with regard to what it would cost the Commonwealth itself to pay for its full-time employees if they were to utilize the full allotted 100% rate.

[01:21:41] And they admit that at this time we're only using 33% of that rate. But then it goes further to say that upon private businesses, it would be an indeterminable physical impact. And I noticed that the Senate's version did not have any small business exemption, unlike the House version.

[01:22:00] So I was thinking, Mr. Speaker, if this isn't a tax, what should we call it? Because I've heard interesting things on the floor this year, like self-funded and things like that. So I thought about this one, and I think this one is an employer-funded. That's what we would call this one.

[01:22:16] This is an employer-funded tax. Basically, if you miss a day of work, your employer still pays you a check for it. So it's an employer tax. All that money that they get comes from consumers. So they're going to have to increase their rates to get the money to pay the employee.

[01:22:35] Now, apply that to Virginia employers. Virginia's the employer. They've got Virginia employees. Where are they going to get the cash? Taxpayers. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass?

[01:23:05] Close the roll. Excuse me. Ayes 63, Nose 35. Ayes 63, Nose 35. The bill passes. Senate Bill 253 at the bottom of page 11 is next up. It seeks to amend and reenact Section Dakota Virginia Land Electric Utilities Pilot Program for Energy Assistance and Weatherization for Certain Individuals.

[01:23:23] Cost Recovery for Certain Electrical Facilities. Legislation report committee on Labor and Commerce with Amendment Nature Substitute. Delegate from Henrico, Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the Labor and Commerce Substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:23:39] the committee subsidies agree to the delegate from here i call delegate louver bowler thank you mr speaker sb 253 is now identical to my house bill 1393 which focuses on three core priorities

protecting customer affordability strengthening grid reliability and maintaining strong oversight by the sec to ensure infrastructure investments are fair and responsible the bill extends and strengthens shareholder funded energy assistance and weatherization programs through 2038 without raising customer rates and with that mr speaker i'd like to move passage of the bill shall the bill

[01:24:08] pass. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 68, ayes 66, noes 32. Ayes 66, noes 32, the bill passes. Over on page 12, we come to Senate Bill 256 to amend the Code of Virginia relating to appliance, minimum energy and water conservation standards, heating, ventilation and air conditioning facilities and home appliances, Department of Energy. Legislation reported from the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[01:24:41] They're from Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB-256 is the cognate and is identical to HB-672 that had previously passed this body. It ensures that if federal energy and water efficiency standards are replaced or decreased, that the current standards as of December 31st, 2025, will be in place so that Virginia is protected.

[01:25:04] Utility bills will be protected, and Virginians will be able to make sure they're having energy efficiency appliances. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:25:22] Ayes, 62, noes, 35. Ayes, 62, noes, 35, the bill passes. Senate Bill 310 now before you seeks to amend the Code of Virginia, amend and reenact portion of the Code of Virginia, excuse me, relating to the State Corporation Commission, time frame for completion of certain proceedings, legislation to support committee on labor and commerce.

[01:25:42] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 310 is identical to my House Bill 466, which passed this chamber with bipartisan support. It will require that within 180 days, the State Corporation Commission must complete application proceedings for certificates, permits, or approvals that are required for the construction, operation, via public utility, of a small renewable energy project, or certain transmission lines.

[01:26:05] I hope it's the will of the body to pass this bill. Shall the bill pass? Close the roll. Ayes.

[01:26:21] 81, no, 17. Ayes, 81, no, 17. The bill passes. Senate Bill 361 is now before you. It seeks to amend and reenact a section of the code of Virginia related to health insurance, coverage for certain contraceptive drugs, devices, and products. Legislation report committee on labor and commerce with an amendment nature of substitute.

[01:26:39] Delegate for President Williams, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Delegate for President Williams, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB 361 is now identical to my House Bill 1182, which requires and ensures to cover the cost of contraceptive and other therapeutics.

[01:26:58] I move that the bill passed. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 65, noes 32. Ayes 65, noes 32.

[01:27:14] The bill passed. Senate Bill 595 seeks to amend and reenact two sections to go to Virginia related to mechanics and storage liens, abandoned vehicles, vehicle records. Legislation 430 on transportation. Beck from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 595 removes the requirement that the DMV reach out to another jurisdiction when searching for owner or lien holder

information for a vehicle titled in another jurisdiction in cases of vehicle abandonment or uncertain liens, but it's the will of the body to pass the bill.

[01:27:44] Shall the bill pass? Truck will close the roll. Ayes. 81, no 17. Ayes 81, no 17. The bill passes.

[01:27:59] Senate Bill 621, before you now, would direct certain electric utilities petition State Corporation Commission for Approval of Electric Grid Utilization Metrics. Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce. Senator from Hiraico, Delegate LaVere Bowling. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:28:15] SB 621 is now identical to my House Bill 434, which passed this body unanimously. The bill puts ratepayers first by requiring utilities and regulators to fully assess how well our existing electric grid is performing before approving expensive new infrastructure that shows up on customer bills with that mr speaker i'd like to move passage of the bill shall the bill pass so close the roll ayes 92 no 6.

[01:28:47] ayes 92 no 6 the bill passes uh senate bill 646 to amend your enact a variety of sections of the code of virginia all relating to labor and employment payment of wages minimum wage and overtime wages misclassification of workers civil actions legislation for committee on labor and of Commerce with an amendment nature of substitute.

[01:29:06] Delegate from Arlington, Dec. Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to the delegate from Arlington, Dec. Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 644 is the cognitive eye bill, strengthening, which strengthens our ability to protect Virginia workers against wage theft, misclassification, failure to pay minimum wage and overtime wages.

[01:29:25] I move we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 63, noes 35.

[01:29:41] Ayes 63, noes 35. The bill passes. Over on page 14 of the printed calendar, we come to Senate Bill 652, which would direct the State Corporation Commission's Bureau of Insurance to submit a report on customer satisfaction information for property and casualty insurance providers. Report legislation reported from the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[01:30:00] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill calls for the Bureau of Insurance to report collected data from property and casualty insurance providers and report them. Through annual funding every year, or binding every year, I move passage of this bill.

[01:30:20] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 87, noes 11. Ayes 87, noes 11, the bill passes.

[01:30:36] Senate Bill 683 seeks to amend and reenact section of the code of Virginia relating to appointment of receiver for waterworks, public waterworks, legislation reporting on health and human services. Dec. from Henrico, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 683 permits the Commissioner of Health to ask the local circuit court to appoint a receiver for any public or private waterworks under current law. Receivership is limited to private waterworks only. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass.

[01:31:02] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 97, no's 1. Ayes 97, no's 1. The bill passes.

[01:31:18] Senate Bill 693, as legislation to amend and reenact section of Virginia relating to motor vehicle insurance, unfair discrimination based on an individual's consumer credit information or credit-based insurance score report. Legislation report activity on labor and commerce with amendments.

[01:31:35] Judge from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, first I move the amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendments are agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, first of all, the amendment simply removes the clause, and it makes the report due on October 2027 instead of October 2026. And what the bill does, it prohibits any insurer from refusing to insure an individual because of the individual's consumer credit score.

[01:32:07] And Mr. Speaker, I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 91, no 7.

[01:32:24] Ayes 91, no 7. The bill passes. Over on page 15, we come to Senate Bill 699, which seeks to amend and re-enact Sex Dakota, Virginia, relating to the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, public bodies to post meeting agendas. Legislation report committee on general laws. That's from Fairfax, Delegate Creasy.

[01:32:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 699 updates the Virginia Freedom of Information Act to require public bodies to post meeting agendas online in advance of meetings when a government website exists. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill passes. Shall the bill pass?

[01:33:01] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0. Ayes 98, noes 0. The bill passes. Senate Bill 803 now before you. Seeks to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia related to Virginia Fair Housing Law. Discriminatory housing practices, quid pro quo, harassment.

[01:33:18] Legislation report on general laws with an amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Kreeseck. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House adopt the general law substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Kreeseck.

[01:33:33] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 803 adds quid pro quo harassment to the statutory list of discriminatory housing practices and defines such harassment within real estate and housing transactions under Virginia law. This change aligns Virginia code to reflect recognized forms of harassment already addressed at the federal level and provides clear legal protections for renters and homeowners.

[01:33:54] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes. 64, noes 34.

[01:34:11] 64, it knows 34, the bill passes. Over on page 16, we come to Senate Bill 818, which seeks to amend and reenact the Texas Code of Virginia Land Electric Utilities, licensed retail suppliers, renewable portfolios, standard requirements, legislation reported for the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[01:34:29] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill simply relates to electric utilities, licensed retail suppliers, and renewable portfolios, standard requirements. Mr. Speaker, I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:34:56] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The bill passes. And then returning to pick up a couple of bills that got moved over on page four of the printed calendar, Senate Bill 396 is now before you. It seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia Land and Driver's Licenses requirements for initial licensure, persons aged 18 to 21, Legislation Report Committee on Transportation, with amendment nature substitute.

[01:35:20] That's from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Fairfax, delegate and donate. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So this bill has now been conformed to my House Bill 1224, which changes the requirements for those obtaining driver's license over the age of 18 and under the age of 21.

[01:35:41] And I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Excuse me. Ayes 91, no 7. Ayes 91, no 7.

[01:35:57] Bill passes. And over on page 6, we pick up the last bill in this category, Senate Bill 767, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia Land and Motor Vehicles, emissions, glass repair, and replacement penalties. Legislation reported from the Committee on Labor and Commerce with Amendment 8 Substitute.

[01:36:16] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Carnegie. Mr. Speaker. Oh, you got this little button right there? You might want to use it? Oh, there you go, because I didn't know you. It's been a long time since I saw you. The Delegate from Chesapeake.

[01:36:32] Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Carnegie. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the Labor and Commerce Committee substitute and ask that the body vote no. Shall the Committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. No. Committee substitute is rejected. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Carnegie.

[01:36:49] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 767 is the cognate to my House Bill 312. Unfortunately, the Senate language is the stronger version as it more clearly addresses the emissions inspection waiver provisions and allows a vehicle to qualify for a waiver under certain conditions when re-inspection cannot be completed, providing the owner submits documentations of attempted repairs.

[01:37:09] The House Labor and Commerce Committee substitute conformed this bill to the engrossed version of My House Bill 312, but with the substitute being rejected, we preserved the original language of Senate Bill 767. When the House adopts the Senate substitute to my bill later on the calendar, the language in both bills will match and no further action will be needed.

[01:37:28] Mr. Speaker, I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:37:44] Close the row. Ayes. 96, no's 2. House 96 knows, too, the bill passes. Mr. Speaker, we come to a new category, House bills with Senate amendments.

[01:38:01] House bills with Senate amendments. Top of page 17, about a dozen or so bills in this new category. Now we come to House Bill 312, which relates to motor vehicle glass repair and replacement penalties. Legislation has passed the House.

[01:38:16] It has passed the Senate with a substitute, which was rejected. And HB 312 is before it has the substitute. I'm back. And you still didn't hit your button. The delegate. She said, I don't know where it is.

[01:38:35] The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Carnegie. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 312 is the House companion to Senate Bill 767. In order to keep both bills in the same posture and allow the Senate bill to serve as the vehicle. Mr. Speaker, I ask that the House vote no on the Senate amendments or Senate substitute to House Bill 312.

[01:38:53] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 1, nos 97.

[01:39:13] Ayes 1, nos 97. The Senate substitute is rejected. With today's calendar, we come next to House Bill 54, House Bill 54, which relates to the Department of Human Resource Management, State Government Internship Coordinator.

[01:39:38] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with amendments, and those Senate amendments to House Bill 54 are now before you. Deputy from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate amendments are technical in nature. They simply renumber some paragraphs and remove a phrase that's unnecessary. So I ask that the House accept the Senate amendments.

[01:39:57] May the Senate amendment be adopted.

[01:40:09] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 96, noes 2. Ayes 96, noes 2. The Senate amendment is adopted. Over on page 18, we come to House Bill 59, which relates to reapportionment, reallocation of populations, civil commitment facilities, legislation rules we pass the House, Senate with substitute, That Senate substitute, the HB 59 is before you.

[01:40:32] Delegate from Powhatan. Delegate Ware. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the Senate substitute and explain that motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 59 ensures that votes of those civilly committed in Virginia are allocated to their last known residents for voting.

[01:40:50] The Senate substitute adds the clarifying phrase, quote, pursuant to Chapter 9 of Title 37.2. That appears four times, and it was done at the request, late arriving, of the Attorney General's office. I move passage of the substitute.

[01:41:08] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:41:18] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0. Ayes 98, noes 0. The bill passes. House Bill 118, now before you, relates to discovery, methods of delivery. Legislation originally passed the House, has passed the Senate with substitute, which is now before you.

[01:41:37] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gamara. Yes, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 118 is a cognate to the Senate Bill 24, and the Senate did a substitute, which I'm asking the body to reject. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:41:57] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 4, noes 94. Ayes 4, noes 94. The Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 190, now before we would direct the Office of the Attorney General to convene a workgroup to review best practices for national institutions in preventing and responding to financial fraud or scams.

[01:42:22] Legislation originally passed the House. I was passed the Senate with the substitute. Senate substitutes now before you. Deb from Virginia Beach, Delegate Cummings, follow. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move that the House agree to the Senate substitute and I'd ask to speak to that substitute. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate substitute to HB 190 reflects changes requested by the Office of the Attorney General simply aiming to narrow the scope of the work group.

[01:42:41] Again, I ask the House to agree to the Senate substitute by voting yes. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 90.

[01:42:57] 7, no, 0. I think 7, no, 0. The Senate amendment is adopted. House Bill 250, now before you, relates to sex offenses prohibiting proximity to children. Park Authorities Act penalty.

[01:43:13] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute, which is now before the box. Back from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that we accept the Senate substitute. Speaking to the motion. Delegate, pass the floor. The Senate substitute simply adds two Roman numerals in the context and the bill, as we passed it, continues to extend the authority to local governments who have park authorities.

[01:43:38] I hope it will be a pleasure to accept the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0.

[01:43:55] Ayes 98, noes 0. The Senate substitute is adopted. Over on page 19, we come to House Bill 325, which relates to the Department of Fire Program's mental health awareness training. Legislation registered to pass the House. House passed Senate with a substitute. Senate substitute to HB 325 is before you.

[01:44:11] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate amendments simply move some language to a different portion of the bill and delete some language to which we are agreeable. So I would ask that the body please accept the Senate amendment.

[01:44:29] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 95, nos, 3.

[01:44:45] Ayes, 95, nos, 3. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 390, now before you, relates to Marine Resource Commission, Habitat Policy Oversight Committee established powers and duties as well as a report. Legislation passed the House of Delegates, subsequently passed it with the Senate substitutes before you.

[01:45:05] Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askey. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate substitute simply adds an additional member from industry, which is subject to the commission's authority, which ultimately brings the committee to 11 members, two non-voting members, and I ask the House to accept the Senate substitute.

[01:45:22] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes 98, no zero. Ayes 98, no zero. The Senate substitute is adopted.

[01:45:38] House Bill 559 now before you relates to Driver Training School and Driver Training Instructors Standards, discipline, report. Legislation originally passed the House. It passed the Senate with a substitute, which is before you. Delegate from Hanover. Delegate White. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute changes the words from shall deny to revoke.

[01:45:58] I will ask that the House accept the Senate substitute. Deep thinkers over there. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:46:16] Ayes, 96, noes, 2. Ayes, 96, noes, 2. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 714. Now, before we would authorize the Department of Conservation and Recreation to convey and acquire property at Leesylvania State Park.

[01:46:31] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed that with the substitute, which is now before the ballot. Deli from Prince William, Doug at Henson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The clerk actually said my lines. The only difference is the substitute is technical in nature that was found by DCR, as that we accept the Senate substitute.

[01:46:47] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 95, no, 96, no, 0. Ayes 96, no, 0. the substitute is adopted. Over to page 20, pentultimate we come to House Bill 817, which relates to state and local hospitalization program, director of medical assistance services, exemption from reporting requirement. Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Delegate from York County, Delegate

[01:47:23] Downey. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute goes further than my bill in removing the entire section of code related to the state local hospitalization program that hasn't been funded since 2009. I move the Senate substitute and ask adoption of the substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0. Ayes 98, noes 0. The Senate substitute is adopted. And last bill in this category, House Bill 1208, which relates to

[01:48:01] public education, early childhood care and education, child care access calculations report. Legislation originally passed the House, substitute passed the Senate with a substitute, the Senate substitutes before you. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1208 establishes a child care access calculation. The Senate version reduces the timeline for the Senate substitute reduces the timeline for the report to be completed, which appears that it could create some problems with the limitations on the depth and value of the findings.

[01:48:31] I move the Senate substitute and ask the House reject the motion. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:48:46] We'll close the roll. Ayes. Zero. No's 98. Zero. No's 98. The Senate's substitute is adopted. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the page 20 memorial resolution Senate Speaker's table has been dispensed with for the one resolution there and similarly with commending resolutions.

[01:49:02] With no conference reports before us at the front desk, that completes today's calendar. Delegate from Fairfax. Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we rejected or we failed to pass the Senate's substitute to House Bill 312 on page 17, I move that we reconsider that vote so that we can all correct our votes.

[01:49:24] Page 17 of the calendar, House Bill 312, relating to motor vehicle glass repair and replacement. All that clapping for nothing. Having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed, we rejected the Senate substitute HB 312 found on page 17.

[01:49:42] The delegate from Fairfax moves that we can reconsider that vote so that everybody can correct their votes. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Mr. Clerk will call up HB 312, the Carnegie Bill. Yes. It is now before you.

[01:49:59] Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of the Senate substitute and encourage the members to please vote yes. Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Falkett County, please add some lucidity to this conversation.

[01:50:15] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would urge everybody to adopt the Senate substitute so that the two bills match and go to the governor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Please, God, shall the bill pass?

[01:50:35] Shall the bill pass? Shall the substitute be adopted? Please. Clerk shall close the roll. Ayes, 96, noes, 2.

[01:50:52] Ayes, 96, noes, 2. The Senate substitute is adopted this time. Again, that completes today's calendar. Per House Rule 51, the House will return to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements about communication?

[01:51:08] No communication, just the meeting schedule in this next to last week of session. The Committee on Labor and Commerce is going to meet a half hour after adjournment of the House. They'll be in House Committee Room A in the lower level. Then once the full committee meets, then it's subcommittee number one will meet upon adjournment of the full committee.

[01:51:28] And once that subcommittee meets, then subcommittee number three. So Labor and Commerce, then sub one, sub three, all down in the lower level. The General Committee for General Laws, ABC Gaming, will be meeting a half hour after 15 minutes after adjournment, so approximately two o'clock-ish.

[01:51:49] General Laws ABC Gaming, they'll be in House Committee Room B. Once that subcommittee of General Laws ABC Gaming is finished, then General Laws Procurement Open Government Subcommittee will meet 15 minutes after that, just to get the room flipped around. And then, so there'll be two subcommittees, and then the full committee on General Laws will meet a half hour right after the subcommittee on procurement.

[01:52:13] So all that will be in Committee Room B. Then the only other legislative meeting is Transportation's Innovations Subcommittee. Subcommittee on Innovations, they're meeting at 4 o'clock. They'll be on the House South Subcommittee room on the second floor.

[01:52:31] So that is at 4. So Labor, General Laws, a couple subs, and Transportation sub rounds out today's activities. Looking ahead to tomorrow, Wednesday, March 4th, we have the Speaker's Interfaith Devotional at 7 a.m. up on the 14th floor in the Speaker's Conference Room.

[01:52:47] We have at 7.30 the Conservative Energy Caucus is meeting. They're on the 7th floor, House North Meeting Room, obviously on the 7th floor, so that's at 7.30. At 8 o'clock, the Military Veterans Caucus is a meeting.

[01:53:03] They'll be in the Senate Subcommittee Room 3. That's at 8. The HBCU Caucus is also meeting tomorrow. They'll be in House Subcommittee Room 10. So all conservatives are at 7.30, Conservative Energy Caucus, and then military and HBCU at 8, and then Delegate Rasul's Committee on Education is meeting at 8 o'clock.

[01:53:26] They are in House Committee Room A on the lower level. Skipping ahead to 10 o'clock, Committee on Appropriations, Higher Education Subcommittee. They'll be meeting at 10 up on the 12th floor of the House Appropriations Committee Room, and then prior to convening tomorrow, the two caucuses will meet.

[01:53:44] The Democratic caucus is meeting 11-15 tomorrow. And the Republican Council meeting at 11, Democrats in House Room 1, Republicans in House Room 2. That completes the announcement I have at this time. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasool. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:53:59] Rise for announcement. Delegate has the floor. The full ad has been changed to at 9 a.m. tomorrow. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Update the calendar accordingly. 9 a.m. tomorrow for education, not

8. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon.

[01:54:19] Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that when the House adjourned the day, it adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that the House do now adjourn. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:54:38] The motion is agreed to the House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.



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